

Fundamentals of Business,

UNR1302

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Grading Method		
Assignments	Week 6	5
Mid Term Examination	Week 7	20
Attendance	Week (1-7)	5
Assignments	Week 11	5
12 th week Examination	Week 12	20
Attendance	Week (8-15)	5
Final Examination	Week 16	40%
		Total 100

COURSE WEEKLY CONTENTS

1. The U.S Business Environment
2. Business Ethics and Social Responsibility
3. Entrepreneurship, New Ventures, and Business Ownership
4. Business Management
5. Organizing the Business
6. Operations Management and Quality part I
7. Operations Management and Quality part II
8. Employee Behavior and Motivation
9. Leadership and Decision Making
10. Leadership and Decision Making (cont.)
11. Human Resources Management and Labor Relations
12. Projects
13. Human Resources Management and Labor Relations (cont.)
14. The global context of business
15. Review

REFERENCES

Textbook

Ronald J. Ebert and Ricky W. Griffin; Business Essentials, Pearson

توجيهات

1- الالتزام بميعاد المحاضرة ودخول القاعة قبل دخول المحاضر.

2- في حالة تأخر الطالب:

- لا يسمح للطالب بفتح باب القاعة او الطرق على الباب او عمل اى تصرف يتسبب في إيقاف المحاضرة وتشتيت الطلاب والمحاضر.
- ينتظر الطالب خارج القاعة حتى يسمح له المحاضر بالدخول.

3- غلق التليفون المحمول او وضعه على الصامت.

4- الالتزام بالاداب والقواعد العامة اثناء المحاضرة.

Ch. 1

The Business Environment

1.1 What is Business?

A business is any organization that provides **goods or services** to earn profit

Goods → cars, food, clothes, furniture

Services → banking, education, transportation, healthcare, telecommunications

1.2 Main Types of Business

1- Manufacturing Businesses:

Convert raw materials into finished products.

(Factories or companies for Food , Textile, Cement, Car, etc...)

2- Trading Businesses:

Buy products and resell them to customers.

(Supermarkets – Wholesalers - Retail stores)

3- Service Businesses:

Provide intangible activities or benefits to customers.

(Banks – Hotels – Universities – Hospitals - Transportation)

1.3 What Is the Business Environment?

The business environment is everything around a business that can affect its activities, decisions, and performance.

The Two Main Parts of the Business Environment

1- Internal Environment:

Factors inside the organization.

2- External Environment:

Factors outside the organization.

1.4 The Internal Environment

Important internal factors include:

1. Employees:

Employees are one of the most important resources of a business.

Their Skills, Knowledge, Motivation, Experience, and Productivity can affect organizational performance.

2. Management:

Managers make decisions concerning: Planning, Organizing, Staffing, Directing, and Controlling.

1.4 The Internal Environment

3. Organizational Culture:

Organizational culture refers to the values, beliefs, and ways of working shared by employees.

4. Financial Resources:

A business needs sufficient financial resources to: Buy materials, Pay employees, Invest in equipment, Expand operations

5. Organizational Structure:

The structure determines: Who reports to whom, Who has authority, and How responsibilities are divided

1.5 The External Environment

The external environment includes factors outside the organization.

Businesses generally have much less control over these factors.

We can divide the external environment into:

A. Micro Environment: Factors that have a direct relationship with the business.

B. Macro Environment: Broader factors that affect businesses and the economy as a whole.

1.5.1 The Micro Environment

The micro environment includes groups that interact directly with the business.

1. Customers:

Businesses need to understand: What customers want, How much they are willing to pay, Their preferences, and Their buying behavior.

Example: If Egyptian consumers become more interested in online shopping, businesses may need to develop e-commerce channels.

2. Suppliers:

Suppliers provide businesses with: Raw materials, Equipment, Components, Energy, and Services.

Example: A food-processing company depends on suppliers for agricultural products and packaging materials. If the cost of raw materials increases, the company's costs may increase.

1.5.1 The Micro Environment

3. Competitors:

Competitors are other organizations offering similar products or services.

Businesses need to monitor: Prices, Quality, Products, Marketing, and Customer service.

Example: Egypt's telecommunications market includes several competing companies.

4. Financial Institutions:

Businesses may depend on banks and other financial institutions for: Loans, Payment services, Investment, and Other financial services

5. Government:

Government institutions can influence businesses through: Laws, Regulations, Taxes, Licensing, and Public policies

1.5.2 The Macro Environment

A useful framework for studying the macro environment is **PESTLE** Analysis:

Political factors: Tax policies, government stability, trade agreements.

Economic factors: Inflation, interest rates, unemployment, currency exchange rates.

Social factors: Population growth, education levels, consumer attitudes.

Technological: AI adoption, new production technologies, internet penetration.

Legal factors: Labor laws, environmental regulations, intellectual property الملكية الفكرية laws.

Environmental factors: Climate change, sustainability requirements, waste management.

1.6 Why Study Business?

- 1- Builds skills for future careers.
- 2- Prepares for entrepreneurship.
- 3- Helps understand the economy and society.
- 4- Encourages innovation and problem-solving.